

NSW LITTLE ATHLETICS

Under 10 Boys

Age Manager's Coaching Guide

Skill progressions for every event, a curated video & article library from Little Athletics Australia and specialist youth-athletics coaches, plus a bank of skills-based games to fill waiting periods.

Beginner → Intermediate progressions • Scan-to-watch video library •
90/10 skills-first games bank

Compiled from official Little Athletics Australia coaching resources and Coaching Young Athletes (Darren Wensor). Always check the current NSW/LAA Rules of Competition and your own centre's program — event offerings can vary slightly by centre.

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How to Use This Guide

This guide covers the standard NSW Little Athletics events most commonly programmed for Under 10 Boys, plus one bonus lead-up skill. For each event you'll find: a quick-facts snapshot, a beginner → intermediate teaching progression, common faults to watch for, a safety note, and a "Watch & Learn" card linking to the best available video or written technique guide.

Every Watch & Learn card includes a QR code. Print this guide and scan the code pitch-side with a phone camera to jump straight to the video or article — no typing long URLs at the track.

Under 10 Age Group, at a Glance

Age definition	Nine years of age as at midnight, 31 December, in the year the season starts (per LAA Standard Rules of Competition).
Footwear	No spike shoes permitted for the U9–10 age group, in any event.
High Jump technique	Scissor technique only — the flop is not a legal technique until U11.
Long Jump take-off	A sand/soft-earth mat, not a board — placed within 0.5m of the landing pit.
Throwing implements	Shot Put 2kg (orange), Discus 500g. Javelin is not offered until U11.
Starting blocks	Not permitted until U11 — all races start from a standing start.

Source: Standard Rules for Competition of Little Athletics Australia Limited. Rules are reviewed periodically — always check the current edition and your own centre's program, since some events (e.g. 60m Hurdles) are offered at the discretion of individual NSW centres.

Under 10 Boys — Events at a Glance

Event	Distance / Implement	Key U10 Rule
Sprints	70m · 100m · 200m	Standing start, run in lanes
Middle Distance	400m · 800m	Standing/group start
Hurdles*	60m · 45cm height	6 flights, collapsible hurdles
4 x 100m Relay	Team event	30m take-over zone
Race Walk	700m	Straight leg, continuous contact
Long Jump	Mat take-off	Mat placed max 0.5m from pit
High Jump	Scissor technique only	Mat 150–300mm high
Shot Put	2kg (orange)	Standing put from the circle
Discus	500g	Standing throw from the circle
Turbo Javelin*	Skill only — not a competition event	Lead-up to U11 Javelin

* Offered at many, but not all, NSW centres — check your own centre's program.

1. Standing Start & Sprints

70m · 100m · 200m

Quick Facts

Distances offered	70m, 100m, 200m (all run in lanes)
Start	Standing start only – starting blocks not permitted until U11
Footwear	No spike shoes for U9–10 age group
Why it matters	Sprinting is the base skill for almost every other event – relays, jumps and hurdles all begin with an efficient start and drive phase.

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Teach the standing start position: front foot on the line, back foot behind, weight forward over the front foot, opposite arm to front leg cocked back.
2. Practise the three commands – “On your marks” (walk to the line), “Set” (still, weight forward), and the gun/whistle (drive away low).
3. Drill the first five steps out of the start as short, powerful, low steps – “push the ground away, don’t reach for it”.
4. Introduce tall running posture over the remaining distance: eyes forward, relaxed shoulders, hands moving pocket-to-cheek.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Add reaction practice – vary the pause between “Set” and the signal so athletes learn to wait for it, not anticipate it.
2. Work on the transition from the low drive phase into upright sprinting, over roughly 15–20m.
3. Introduce simple relaxation cues for the middle of the race – “loose jaw, loose hands” – to stop athletes tightening up and slowing down.
4. Practise a strong finish: run through the line rather than leaning, dipping or looking sideways at competitors.

Common Faults to Watch For

- Standing up out of the drive phase too early – keep the shin angle low for the first steps.
- False-starting by anticipating the signal – fix with more “Set-and-hold” reps.
- Looking at other runners mid-race, which twists the body and costs speed.

SAFETY

Always start sprints with athletes facing away from other events in progress, and keep the finish chute clear of officials and younger siblings.

Watch & Learn



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Part 1: Standing Start

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

Qualified coach demonstrates grip, stance and the three starting commands, matched to Little Athletics rules.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://youtu.be/qtLAO-rgGOW>



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Part 2: Running Technique

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

Covers arm drive, posture and stride mechanics for beginner sprinters.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://youtu.be/nqZXwJyALyg>

2. Middle Distance Running

400m · 800m

Quick Facts

Distances offered	400m (in lanes), 800m (lanes for first bend, then break)
Key skill	Even pacing – most U10 boys go off too fast and fade
Start	Standing start, group start for the 800m

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Use the same standing start and tall running posture taught for sprints – the technique doesn't change, only the effort level does.
2. Teach the idea of “cruise pace” versus “sprint pace” using simple language: “run like you could hold a conversation for the first half”.
3. Practise breathing rhythm – in for two steps, out for two steps – to stop early panic breathing.
4. Walk the 800m break-line rule so athletes know exactly where they can move off their lane.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Introduce simple even-split practice: time the first and second half of a 400m and aim to keep them close together.
2. Teach a controlled last-100m kick, saved for the final stretch rather than used early.
3. Practise running comfortably in a pack for the 800m without being boxed in on the rail.

Common Faults to Watch For

- Sprinting the first 100m of an 800m and running out of energy – fix with pace-judgement games (see Games section).
- Holding the breath or breathing erratically under fatigue.
- Drifting wide on bends, which adds distance – cue “hug the inside line” where lanes allow.

SAFETY

In the 800m, brief athletes clearly on where the break-line is before the race so the move from lanes to single file happens safely.

Watch & Learn



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Part 2: Running Technique

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

The same running-technique fundamentals apply at middle-distance pace – use this as your technical reference.

Scan the QR code, or open:
<https://youtu.be/nqZXwJyALyg>

3. Hurdles

60m hurdles · 45cm

Quick Facts

Height	45cm hurdles (collapsible type) for U9–10
Layout	6 flights over 60m – 12m run-in, 7m between flights, 13m run-out
Offered	Many, but not all, NSW centres run this at U10 – check your centre's program

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Start with hurdle mobility, not hurdling: walk over hurdles lying flat, then on their side, before raising them.
2. Teach the lead-leg action as a “step over a puddle” – knee drives up and through, not a jump.
3. Teach the trail leg to fold tight and sweep through low and fast, heel close to the bottom.
4. Keep the very first hurdles low and close together so athletes get rhythm before speed.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Introduce a consistent stride pattern between hurdles (most U10s will settle on an odd number of strides, commonly 5).
2. Work on “attacking” the hurdle with the chest, rather than sitting back and floating over it.
3. Add a controlled approach run so athletes arrive at the first hurdle on the correct stride, not chopping their steps.

Common Faults to Watch For

- Jumping the hurdle with two feet together, like a show-jumping horse – always one leg leads.
- Ducking the head and shoulders down, which slows the whole action.
- Braking before the hurdle instead of running through it.

SAFETY

Hurdles must only ever be cleared from the correct direction – clearing them backwards stops them from collapsing safely and can cause injury.

Watch & Learn



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Part 3: Hurdles

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

Demonstrates lead-leg and trail-leg mechanics using Little Athletics hurdle heights and spacing.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://youtu.be/7w8iWGBmO4k>

4. 4 x 100m Relay & Baton Change

Team event

Quick Facts

Change zone	30m take-over zone, scratch line 20m in
Baton rule	Must be carried by hand and passed within the zone
Key skill	A clean, fast hand-to-hand exchange matters more than any one runner's top speed

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Start stationary: pairs stand still, practise the verbal cue ("Hand!") and the hand-to-hand exchange without any running.
2. Teach one simple pass method consistently – the push pass (receiver's palm up and steady, incoming runner places the baton firmly into it) is easiest for beginners.
3. Add walking, then jogging exchanges before ever running at speed.
4. Teach the receiver to hold their hand steady and let the incoming runner do the work – don't snatch at the baton.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Introduce the take-over zone and a simple "go-mark" – a spot the receiver starts moving from when the incoming runner reaches it.
2. Practise exchanges at increasing speed, always prioritising a clean pass over an early, risky one.
3. Rehearse full team changeovers in the actual lanes you'll race in, so athletes are comfortable with the layout on competition day.

Common Faults to Watch For

- Receiver looking back for the baton (for the 4x100m) instead of trusting the verbal cue and reaching back – build this up gradually, it's a confidence skill.
- Receiver starting too early or too late relative to the incoming runner – fix with go-mark practice.
- Baton passed outside the take-over zone – always rehearse the zone markings before race day.

SAFETY

Keep spare batons and a clear marshalling system so teams aren't rushed into the zone – most drops happen when kids feel hurried.

Watch & Learn



ARTICLE How to Teach Kids Circular Relay Baton Changes

Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes

A full 30–40 minute session plan, from stationary passes through to full-speed changeovers, written specifically for youth/Little Athletics groups.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2016/10/27/how-to-teach-kids-circular-relay-baton-changes/>

5. Race Walk

700m

Quick Facts

Distance	700m for U9–10
Legal technique	Straight leading leg at contact; some part of the foot must appear to stay in contact with the ground at all times

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Teach the straight-leg contact rule first, slowly, before worrying about speed at all: “knee locks straight the moment your foot lands”.
2. Practise a visible hip rotation/roll – it’s what generates speed without breaking contact or bending the knee.
3. Keep arms bent at roughly 90 degrees, driving front-to-back close to the body.
4. Start every session with slow-motion walking to groove the technique before adding pace.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Gradually build cadence (steps per minute) while keeping technique legal – speed should come from quicker, not longer, steps.
2. Add short pace changes so athletes learn to speed up without lifting off the ground (a common disqualification risk).
3. Practise racing in a small group so athletes get used to walking near others without breaking technique.

Common Faults to Watch For

- “Creeping” – a visible loss of contact with the ground, which is effectively running.
- Bent knee at contact, which is the most common reason for a caution.
- Excessive up-and-down body movement instead of the hip roll – wastes energy.

SAFETY

Race walking is a genuine technical event – avoid letting it turn into a race-to-run; slow it right down and prioritise legal technique over speed.

Watch & Learn



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Racewalking

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

Explains the straight-leg and continuous-contact rules with visual demonstration.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://youtu.be/HY7Z07WJaNc>

6. Long Jump

Mat take-off

Quick Facts

Take-off	0.5m x 1.22m mat covered in damp sand/soft earth, placed max 0.5m from the pit
Measurement	From the take-off imprint to the nearest break in the sand
Footwear	No spikes for U9–10

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Start with a standing long jump – two feet to two feet – to build the arm swing and landing habit (“land like a frog”, knees bent, arms forward).
2. Progress to a one-foot take-off, two-foot landing, from a walk-in approach of just a few steps.
3. Find each athlete’s natural take-off foot before formalising a run-up – most kids will show a clear preference.
4. Keep the very first run-ups short (4–6 strides) – accuracy matters far more than speed at this stage.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Measure and mark a consistent run-up starting point, matching stride count roughly to age (a longer run-up isn’t automatically better for U10s).
2. Teach the last two strides as “down-up” – a slightly lower second-last step, then drive up and out at take-off.
3. Add knee-and-arm drive at take-off to hang in the air longer, then reach the legs forward to land.

Common Faults to Watch For

- Taking off from two feet, which is not a legal jump – revisit the standing jump progression if this happens often.
- Looking down at the mat while running in, which shortens and slows the last strides.
- Sitting back on landing instead of reaching the feet forward – costs measured distance.

SAFETY

Rake the sand pit level and check for hidden edges or debris before each session; make sure no athlete starts their run-up until the pit is clear.

Watch & Learn



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Part 5: Long Jump

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

Covers the mat take-off method used at U9–10 level, run-up and landing technique.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://youtu.be/DoC6HAIK8mc>



ARTICLE How to Teach a Long Jump Run-Up in 7 Easy Steps

Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes

A simple, age-based method for measuring and marking a repeatable run-up.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2015/08/10/how-to-teach-a-long-jump-run-up-in-7-easy-steps/>

7. High Jump (Scissor Technique)

Scissor technique only

Quick Facts

Rule	Scissor technique is the ONLY legal technique for U8, U9 and U10 – the flop is not permitted
Mat height	Scissor mats 150–300mm high, minimum 5m x 3m
Legal jump	Lead foot must touch the mat before any other body part; head must not clear the bar before the lead leg

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Start with no bar at all – athletes run in from an angle and simply step up onto the mat, getting used to the run-in angle and the mat.
2. Add a soft, flexible bar (foam/elastic) before ever using a real crossbar, so early misses aren't discouraging.
3. Teach the approach as a straight line at roughly 30–40 degrees to the bar – not side-on, not head-on.
4. Teach the outside leg as the take-off leg, kicking the inside leg up and over first.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Introduce a real crossbar at a low, achievable height once the run-in and leg action are consistent.
2. Work on a straight lead-leg kick (not a bent-knee drive) so the leg fully clears the bar.
3. Teach athletes to finish “seated” or standing on the far mat, landing on their feet or seat, never on their back or head.

Common Faults to Watch For

- Approaching the bar side-on or straight-on instead of at an angle – makes clearing the bar with a scissor action very difficult.
- Head crossing the bar before the lead leg – an illegal jump under the scissor rule.
- Landing on the back or head – stop and reset technique immediately if this happens, it's a safety issue, not just a rules one.

SAFETY

Never allow flop-style backward landings at this age – the scissor rule exists specifically because U9–10 landing mats are shallower than senior flop beds.

Watch & Learn



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Part 7: High Jump

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

Demonstrates the scissor technique and the legal-jump rules that apply through to U10.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://youtu.be/U6WcNbUHK6I>



ARTICLE How To Teach Kids To Scissors High Jump

Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes

A step-by-step beginner progression – no-bar, to flexi-bar, to real bar – plus common mistakes to watch for.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2019/12/08/how-to-teach-kids-to-scissors-high-jump/>

8. Shot Put

2kg (orange)

Quick Facts

Implement	2kg shot (orange) for U9–10
Technique	Standing put from inside the circle – no glide or rotation needed at this age
Grip	Shot rests on the base of the fingers, not the palm, tucked under the jaw against the neck

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Teach the grip and hold first, without throwing: “elbows up, thumbs down, palms out”, shot resting against the neck under the jaw.
2. Start front-on to the target with feet parallel, and practise a simple one-arm “put” – pushing, not throwing, the shot away from the neck.
3. Rehearse the action often without the shot itself, especially with younger or first-time athletes.
4. Reinforce the “put” motion, not a baseball-style throw – the shot should be pushed off the neck in one straight line.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Introduce a slightly open (side-on) stance to allow a small hip and shoulder turn into the put.
2. Add a rock back onto the rear foot and drive forward through the legs before the arm finishes the put.
3. Teach a full extension finish, “thumb down”, with the throwing arm following through toward the target.

Common Faults to Watch For

- Holding the shot in the palm rather than the fingers – makes control difficult and can strain the wrist.
- Throwing the shot like a ball instead of putting it – fix by returning to close-range pushes.
- Stepping out of the front of the circle before the put is measured – always wait for the judge’s signal.

SAFETY

Never allow athletes to walk in front of, or collect implements from, the throwing sector until a judge signals it is safe to do so.

Watch & Learn



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Part 9: Shot Put

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

Shows the standing put technique, grip and safe circle conduct used at Little Athletics level.

Scan the QR code, or open:

https://youtu.be/55P_AgPJ0WM



ARTICLE How to Teach Shot Put to Young Athletes

Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes

A ready-to-run group session plan, including cues for common beginner grip and stance errors.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2017/05/29/how-to-teach-shot-put-to-young-athletes/>

9. Discus

500g

Quick Facts

Implement	500g discus for U9–10
Technique	Standing throw from inside the circle – no spin/rotation needed at this age
Grip	Discus rests flat along the finger pads, thumb resting lightly on top – not gripped tightly

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Teach the grip with a simple image: fingers are “shy little people” peeking over the edge of the discus, spread evenly around the rim.
2. Teach the “discus sandwich” starting position – both hands together holding the discus, side-on to the target.
3. Practise a standing throw with a simple weight shift: rock back onto the rear foot as the arm swings back, then rock forward and “unmake the sandwich” to release.
4. Rehearse the swing-and-release action often without letting go, to build confidence in the motion.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Add a small hip and shoulder turn into the release, keeping the arm long and relaxed rather than tense.
2. Work on releasing the discus off the index finger with a flat, spinning action rather than a wobble.
3. Introduce a controlled follow-through and reminder to stay inside the circle until the throw is measured.

Common Faults to Watch For

- Gripping the discus too tightly in the palm – it should rest on the finger pads and spin freely off the index finger.
- Releasing off-balance or falling out of the front of the circle before the throw lands.
- “Throwing” with a bent, whipping arm instead of a longer, more relaxed swing.

SAFETY

Always throw inside a cage or with a clear, marshalled landing sector; keep waiting athletes behind a marked line, well clear of the circle and cage netting.

Watch & Learn



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Part 11: Discus

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

Demonstrates grip, stance and the standing throw used at this age group.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://youtu.be/vDIUI5CHPjk>



ARTICLE How to Teach Discus to Young Athletes

Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes

The “discus sandwich” teaching sequence for groups, from grip through to a full standing throw.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2017/06/26/how-to-teach-discus-to-young-athletes/>

10. Bonus: Turbo Javelin (Lead-Up Skill)

Not a competition event until U11

Quick Facts

Status	Javelin is not a standard NSW/LAA event until U11 – treat this purely as a fun, low-stakes lead-up skill
Implement	A soft turbo jav / vortex-style implement, never a real javelin, is appropriate at this age

Teaching Progression — Beginner

1. Use an overarm throwing action identical to a good cricket or tennis throw – side-on, non-throwing arm pointing at the target.
2. Keep throws short and safe, in a wide, clearly marshalled fan-shaped area with a single thrower at a time.
3. Focus purely on a safe, confident overarm release – there is no benefit in teaching a formal run-up at this age.

Teaching Progression — Intermediate

1. Add a few walking steps into the throw once the overarm action is safe and consistent.
2. Introduce simple distance and accuracy games (see the Games section) to keep this light and enjoyable.

Common Faults to Watch For

- Throwing side-arm (like a discus) instead of overarm – the most common and important thing to correct early.
- Groups standing in the landing sector – always throw in one direction only, into open space.

SAFETY

Because this isn't a competition event for this age group, keep sessions playful and low-pressure – the goal is safe habits for later, not performance now.

Watch & Learn



VIDEO Coaching Video Series – Part 10: Javelin

Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)

Full javelin technique for reference – use only the overarm throwing action and adapt it to a turbo jav for this age group.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://youtu.be/Sz3WRSOZW2c>

Waiting-Period Games

Games in this guide follow a 90/10 split: about 90% are skills games that quietly rehearse a real event technique, and 10% are pure fun with no coaching agenda — used sparingly and deliberately, not as a default.

“Low levels of activity plus long waiting periods equals demotivated kids.” That’s the core problem this section solves. The fix isn’t more standing around – it’s turning the wait itself into practice. Most of the games below rehearse a specific event skill; a small number are there purely to let off steam.



ARTICLE Coaching Kids? 3 Important Words of Advice

Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes

Background reading on why games matter more than drills for keeping large groups engaged during long waits between turns.

Scan the QR code, or open:

<https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2015/09/21/coaching-kids-3-important-words-of-advice/>

Reaction & Start Games — Skill Games

Cone Clean-Up Race

Scatter 20–30 cones/domes across a square area with a bin in two opposite corners. On “go”, athletes run one cone at a time to either bin, then reset and race the clock again. Between rounds, teach a standing start and have athletes use it to launch into the next round – a clean way to sneak in start-position reps disguised as a game.

Hoop Monster

Athletes wait safely inside a hoop each (their “safe base” while waiting for a turn at an event). When the “monster” (coach or a nominated athlete) has their back turned, everyone must sprint to a different free hoop without being tagged. Directly rehearses reactive sprinting off a stationary position – and doubles as your waiting-turn management system.

Jump Games — Skill Games

Step-and-Stick Ladder

Lay markers at increasing gaps leading into the long jump pit. Athletes walk, then jog, then run the ladder, landing on each marker in turn before a final jump into the pit. Reinforces a consistent first-few-strides pattern, the single most common fix for an inconsistent long jump run-up.

Scissor Steps (no bar)

In pairs, athletes take turns running in at a 30-degree angle and stepping straight up onto the high jump mat – no bar, no pressure, just grooving the approach angle and take-off leg while others wait their turn nearby.

Throwing Games — Skill Games

Target Hoops

Set out hoops as targets roughly 8–10m from a throwing line. In pairs or small groups, athletes take turns trying to land a shot, discus or turbo jav inside a hoop on the full. Works for any throwing event and rewards control over raw power – exactly what beginners need most.

Adapted from An Athletics Throwing Game That Kids Will Love

<https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2019/02/25/an-athletics-throwing-game-that-kids-will-love/>



Relay & Baton Games — Skill Games

Baton Down the Line

Teams line up single-file, an arm's length apart, facing forward with their receiving hand held back. On “go”, the baton is passed hand-to-hand down the line without anyone turning around. First team to raise the baton at the front wins the round. Pure non-visual exchange practice, with zero running required – ideal for a tight waiting area.

3 Of The Best Relay Baton Games For Athletics

<https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2020/04/20/3-of-the-best-relay-baton-games-for-athletics/>



Hurdles Shuttle Relay

Two lines of low hurdles set up shuttle-relay style. Athletes clear a short line of hurdles, tag a teammate, who clears them back the other way. Combines hurdle rhythm practice with the cooperative fun of a relay, and works even with only two or three hurdles per lane.

Games That Kids Love: The Hurdles Shuttle Relay

<https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2015/07/08/games-that-kids-love-the-hurdles-shuttle-relay/>



The 10%: Just for Fun

Freeze Tag

One classic, no-skill-agenda game, kept short and used sparingly – typically at the very end of a session, or if energy and attention have completely dropped. One or two “taggers” try to freeze everyone else with a tag; a frozen player can be unfrozen by a teammate crawling through their legs. This is the 10% – pure fun, no drills attached, and all the more valued for being the exception.

Sample Session Run-Sheet

A worked example showing the 90/10 balance in a typical 60–65 minute Saturday morning session covering two events. Adjust timings to suit your centre's roster and number of events on the day.

Segment	Activity	Type
Arrival – 5 min	Free play / Hoop Monster while athletes arrive and sign in.	<i>Fun/Reaction</i>
Warm-up – 5 min	Jog, dynamic stretches, then 2–3 short strides at increasing pace.	<i>General</i>
Skill focus – 15 min	Main teaching block for today's event (e.g. Long Jump beginner progression).	<i>Skill</i>
Rotation to next event – 5–10 min	Cone Clean-Up Race or Target Hoops while waiting for the next group/official.	<i>Skill game</i>
Second skill focus – 15 min	Second event of the day (e.g. Shot Put beginner progression).	<i>Skill</i>
Waiting/marshalling – 5–10 min	Baton Down the Line or Step-and-Stick Ladder, depending on space available.	<i>Skill game</i>
Cool-down / free time – 5 min	Freeze Tag or similar – the session's one "just for fun" slot.	<i>Fun</i>

Full Resource Library

Every video and article used in this guide, gathered in one place for quick reference.

Resource	Source	Link
Standing Start & Sprints — Coaching Video Series – Part 1: Standing Start	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/qtLAO-rgGOW
Standing Start & Sprints — Coaching Video Series – Part 2: Running Technique	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/nqZXwJyALyg
Middle Distance Running — Coaching Video Series – Part 2: Running Technique	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/nqZXwJyALyg
Hurdles — Coaching Video Series – Part 3: Hurdles	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/7w8iWGBmO4k
4 x 100m Relay & Baton Change — How to Teach Kids Circular Relay Baton Changes	Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2016/10/27/how-to-teach-kids-circular-relay-baton-changes/
Race Walk — Coaching Video Series – Racewalking	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/HY7Z07WJaNc
Long Jump — Coaching Video Series – Part 5: Long Jump	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/DoC6HAik8mc
Long Jump — How to Teach a Long Jump Run-Up in 7 Easy Steps	Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2015/08/10/how-to-teach-a-long-jump-run-up-in-7-easy-steps/
High Jump (Scissor Technique) — Coaching Video Series – Part 7: High Jump	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/U6WcNbUHK6I
High Jump (Scissor Technique) — How To Teach Kids To Scissors High Jump	Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2019/12/08/how-to-teach-kids-to-scissors-high-jump/
Shot Put — Coaching Video Series – Part 9: Shot Put	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/55P_AgPJ0WM
Shot Put — How to Teach Shot Put to Young Athletes	Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2017/05/29/how-to-teach-shot-put-to-young-athletes/
Discus — Coaching Video Series – Part 11: Discus	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/vDIUI5CHPjk
Discus — How to Teach Discus to Young Athletes	Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2017/06/26/how-to-teach-discus-to-young-athletes/
Bonus: Turbo Javelin (Lead-Up Skill) — Coaching Video Series – Part 10: Javelin	Little Athletics Australia (official coaching series)	https://youtu.be/Sz3WRS0ZW2c

Target Hoops	Adapted from An Athletics Throwing Game That Kids Will Love	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2019/02/25/an-athletics-throwing-game-that-kids-will-love/
Baton Down the Line	3 Of The Best Relay Baton Games For Athletics	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2020/04/20/3-of-the-best-relay-baton-games-for-athletics/
Hurdles Shuttle Relay	Games That Kids Love: The Hurdles Shuttle Relay	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2015/07/08/games-that-kids-love-the-hurdles-shuttle-relay/
Coaching Kids? 3 Important Words of Advice	Darren Wensor, Coaching Young Athletes	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/2015/09/21/coaching-kids-3-important-words-of-advice/
Little Athletics Australia — full Coaching Video hub	Little Athletics Australia	https://www.littleathletics.com.au/education-training/video-resources/coaching-video-resources/
LAA Standard Rules for Competition (current edition)	Little Athletics Australia	https://www.littleathletics.com.au/wp-content/uploads/2024/08/LAA-Standard-Rules-for-Competition-July-2024_V2.pdf
Coaching Young Athletes — full blog	Darren Wensor	https://coachingyoungathletes.com/